

# Gaps and Overlaps When We Measure

Kindergarten–Grade 1

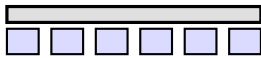
*Laying units with no gaps or overlaps, spotting a gap or overlap mistake, and fixing the count*

**Directions:** Every child on this page measured with the **same size cubes**.

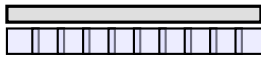
- Some children laid their cubes the **good** way. Some left **gaps**. Some let the cubes **overlap**.
- Look at the picture first. Then answer with a number, a symbol, or a drawing.
- When a question says *find the mistake*, tell what the child did wrong *and* write the right answer.



**GOOD.** No gaps and no overlaps.



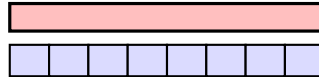
**GAPS.** Spaces are left, so too few cubes fit.



**OVERLAPS.** Cubes sit on top of each other, so too many fit.

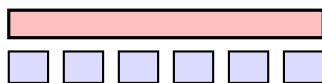
*How cubes are laid down. No numbers are shown here — count the cubes in each problem's own picture.*

- 1.** Ivy laid her cubes under the red ribbon. There are **no gaps** and **no overlaps**. Count Ivy's cubes. How long is the ribbon?



**Answer:** \_\_\_\_\_ cubes

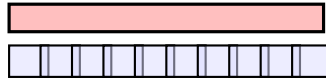
2. Max measured the **same** red ribbon. He left gaps, so he counted only 6 cubes. Ivy measured it carefully and got 8 cubes.



Write  $<$  or  $>$  in the box to tell the truth about Max's number:

Max's count  real length

**3. Find the mistake.** Rex measured the **same** red ribbon. He let his cubes sit on top of each other, counted 10, and said “the ribbon is 10 cubes long.”



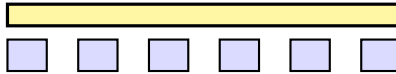
- (a) Tell Rex what he did wrong.      (b) Write the ribbon's real length.

**Answer:** \_\_\_\_\_ cubes

**4.** Rex counted 10 cubes. Ivy counted 8 cubes. They measured the same ribbon. How many **more** cubes did Rex count than Ivy?

**Answer:** \_\_\_\_\_ cubes

**5. Find the mistake.** Sam measured a yellow straw. He left gaps between his cubes and counted 6. A careful measure shows the straw is really 10 cubes long.



(a) Tell Sam what he did wrong.      (b) How many cubes did Sam's gaps hide?

**Answer:** \_\_\_\_\_ cubes

**6.** Rex says: "I counted 10 cubes and Ivy only counted 8, so my measuring is better."  
Is Rex right? Draw a picture of the ribbon and the cubes, and tell how you know.